

As you complete the Career Preparation Modules and related readings, activities and assignments you have created a Job Search Strategy that is unique to you. Use the following template to document your job search plan at this point in time. As you begin to implement your plan your goals, motivations, job interests, etc. may change. Therefore continue to use this template as way to keep yourself accountable and focused to find a job, employer and career that best fits your needs and is unique to you.

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List your career goals. - Module 2 - Using the SMART goal method develop your list of 3-4 Career goals.

Insert your 3-4 SMART career goals here.

Goal 1: Secure a Summer 2027 AI/ML co-op by submitting 20+ applications starting Fall 2026. Co-op eligible from Spring 2026.

Goal 2: Complete AWS ML Specialty or Google Professional ML Engineer certification by December 2026.

Goal 3: Publish 2 production-ready AI projects on GitHub with READMEs and demos by September 2026.

Goal 4: Secure a full time AI/ML Engineer offer by June 2027 using co-op experience and MS AI degree (graduating Dec 2027).

List your experience, skills and strengths. Reflect back on the readings and activities you completed in Module 4 – Build Your Brand. Create a list of your top 5 skills and your top 5 strengths. Include a brief example for at least 3 of your top skills, i.e., how you demonstrated the skill, and a brief example for at least 3 of your top 3 strengths, i.e., how you demonstrated the strength.

Insert your top 3 skills with your examples and your top 3 strengths with examples here.

Top 4 Skills:

1. Python & ML Frameworks — Built production RAG system (Ask My Docs) with LangChain, ChromaDB, and RAGAS evaluation scoring above 0.90.
2. LLMs & RAG — Built Salary Optimization Advisor using Groq API with dynamic prompt engineering based on role and experience.
3. Computer Vision — Built Emotion Recognition System at ACMEGRADE achieving ~90% accuracy using CNN, TensorFlow, and OpenCV.
4. Full-Stack AI Development — Deployed multiple AI apps including Salary Advisor (Flask) and Spell Corrector (Streamlit).

Top 4 Strengths:

1. Cross-Domain Thinking — ECE + AI/ML background bridges hardware and software, demonstrated at ACMEGRADE with real-time face detection pipelines.
2. Research Mindset — Co-authored Springer ICISSC-2025 paper on Emotion-Responsive AI independently during undergraduate studies.
3. Problem-Solving — Built 16-module production RAG system solving retrieval precision and reranking challenges without supervision.
4. Fast Learner — Transitioned from ECE hardware to full-stack LLM/AI

Create your list of companies you'd like to work for from the list you created in Module 3 – Researching the Job Market. Modify the list to include 6-8 companies that interest you the most. This is an opportunity to not only list the companies but also include comments why you would like to work there.

Insert your list of the top 6-8 companies and why you would like to work for them here

1. NVIDIA — GPU and AI computing leader. Deep learning and ML skills directly align with their CUDA and AI framework teams. Based in Santa Clara, CA.
2. Adobe — Rapidly growing AI platform (Firefly, Sensei AI). My computer vision and LLM experience fits their creative AI engineering roles.
3. Salesforce AI — Leader in enterprise AI (Einstein platform). My RAG and LLM development experience is directly applicable.
4. Cisco AI — AI for networking and security. My cross-domain ECE and AI background is a strong fit. Actively hires Northeastern co-op students.
5. Intuitive Surgical — Robotic-assisted surgery using computer vision and AI. Aligns with my CV background and real-world applied AI interest.
6. Plus.ai — Autonomous trucking using real-time computer vision. Matches my embedded systems thinking and CV experience.
7. Google (DeepMind / Applied AI) — Global AI leader. My RAG, NLP, and LLM experience aligns with their applied AI engineering teams.

Create a “to-do” list prior to starting your job search. An effective “to do” list is not just a list of things that you plan to do. Instead it is a list of things you plan to do that includes prioritization and due dates.

Some examples of action items include: researching your top 5 companies of interest to learn more about what they do and their company culture. Or a list of the top 5 job descriptions you plan to research. Or creating a list of your professional references and contacting these references to request permission to use their name and contact information should an employer request your list.

Create a “to-do” list of the top 5 items that you plan to accomplish as you start your job search. Set realistic deadlines when each item should be finished so that you are accountable and more likely to complete all tasks. After writing down your “to-do list” items, add the items into a calendar or schedule.

Insert your “to-do” list below. Include realistic dates when you plan to complete each task. Note that this is your “to-do” list at this point in time. As you complete the tasks you will continue to add more to your list.

1. Complete Northeastern ISSS co-op authorization — Deadline: July 2026
2. Tailor resume and LinkedIn for each target company and role — Deadline: August 2026
3. Apply to 20+ AI/ML co-op positions for Summer 2027 — Deadline: Sept – Oct 2026
4. Reach out to 10 AI/ML professionals on LinkedIn for referrals and networking — Deadline: September 2026
5. Complete LeetCode NeetCode 150 and ML interview prep — Deadline: Sept – Dec 2026

What is your professional brand? Refer to Module 4 – Build Your Brand – the module in which you created your Professional Introduction (Elevator Pitch).

Include your written Professional Introduction (Elevator Pitch) here.

Hi, I'm Chidvilash , most people call me Chidvi. I'm a first-year MS AI student at Northeastern University's Silicon Valley campus, and I don't just study AI , I build with it.

I built a production-grade RAG application ,Ask My Docs with hybrid retrieval and RAGAS evaluation. I also built a full-stack AI salary advisor using Flask and the Groq API. These aren't just class projects they're systems real engineering teams build.

What makes me different is my background. I come from ECE engineering with an AI/ML minor giving me rare cross-domain thinking that bridges hardware and software.

I became co-op eligible in Spring 2026 and I'm actively preparing for Summer 2027. I'm looking for a role where I can contribute to something real.

Participate in networking opportunities - Module 5 – Building Your Network. Review the sites for On campus and Off campus Networking events. (Websites included in the module) Check out different Networking events and identify the ones you are interested to attend. Register for the event!

Insert a list of 3-4 Networking events you plan to attend here

1. Northeastern University Co-op & Career Fair, Fall 2026 — On-campus event to meet recruiters from target companies directly.
2. Silicon Valley AI & ML Meetup (Meetup.com), Monthly from July 2026 — Local Bay Area networking for AI/ML professionals and students.
3. Grace Hopper Celebration (GHC), October 2026 — Large tech gathering with recruiters from NVIDIA, Google, Adobe, and Salesforce.
4. NeurIPS / ICML Student Networking Sessions ,December 2026 — Top AI/ML conferences with student networking tracks and industry connections.